Testing the Infinite Plane in Kerkythea: Adding Water Material to a Google Street View Panorama

By PC-Trace · July 16, 2026 · Category: Kerkythea

This is a quick note from a coffee-break experiment with Kerkythea's built-in **Infinite Plane** model, found under *Model → Infinite Plane*. The goal was simple: apply a water material to the plane and see how it looks combined with a real-world 360° panorama.

The Process

1. Download a 360° panorama from a Google Maps Street View location in New Zealand using DownloadMapImage.com's 360° Street View Downloader.
2. In Kerkythea, apply a water material to the Infinite Plane model. Positioning the plane at roughly the horizontal midline of the scene makes it much easier to align the landscape with the water surface.
3. Render the scene.

The New Zealand Street View panorama used for this test can be viewed here on Google Maps.

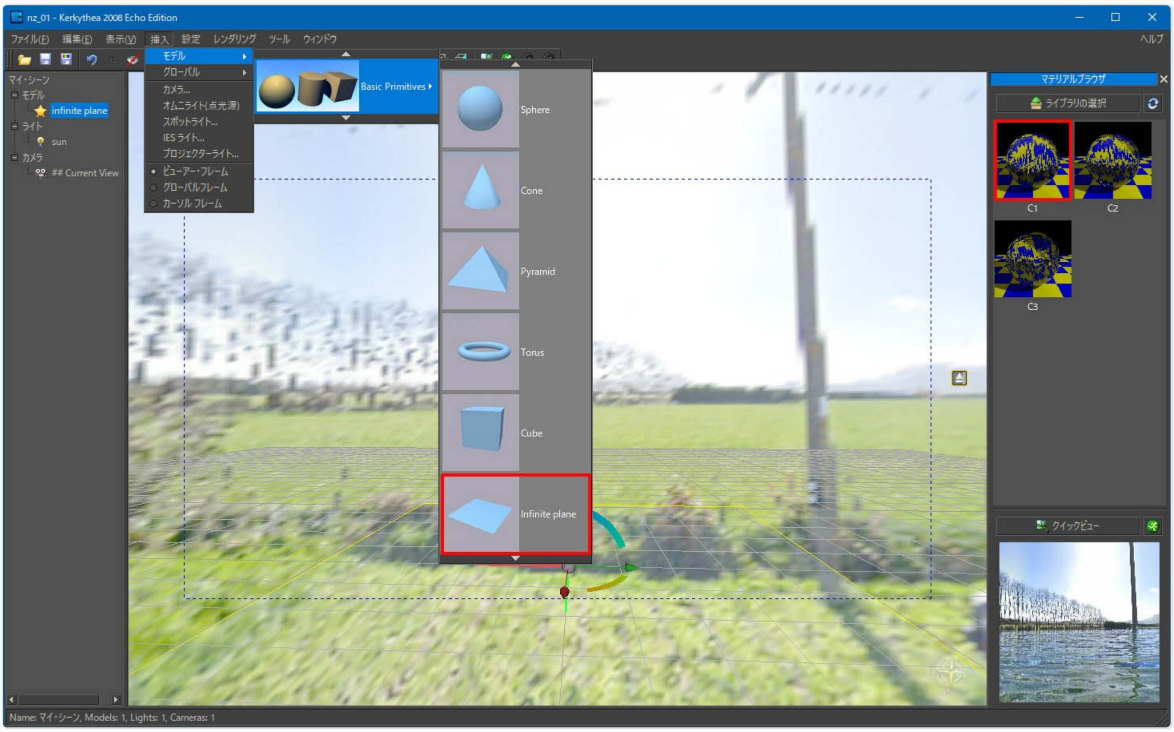
Step 1: Grab the Panorama from Street View

Find a location you like in Google Street View, copy its address from the browser, and paste it into the address field of DownloadMapImage.com's 360° Street View Downloader to download the panorama image.

Google Street View scene near Motukarara, Canterbury, New Zealand, the source panorama for this test.

Step 2: Set Up the Infinite Plane and Water Material

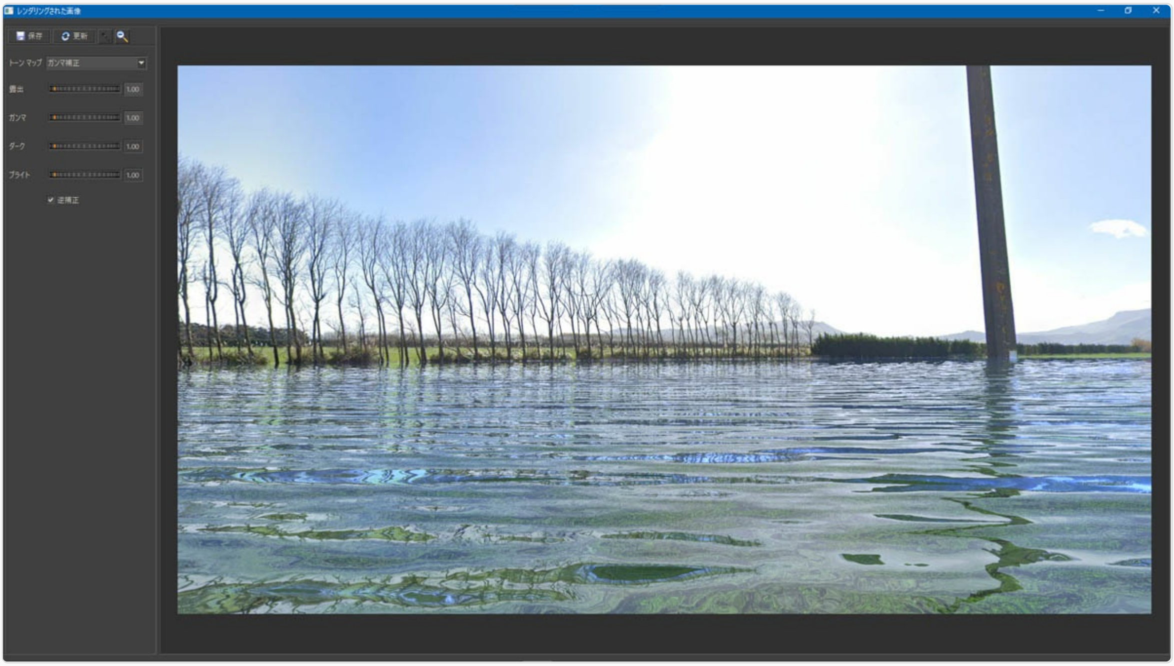
Once you've settled on a good camera angle, insert the Infinite Plane model and assign the water material to it.



Inserting the Infinite Plane model in Kerkythea and assigning a water material from the Material Browser.

Step 3: Render

The full render below took under 10 minutes from start to finish.



Final render: the field is transformed into a flooded landscape with realistic water reflections.

The water material currently implemented in Kerkythea is still very much a work in progress. This was purely an exploratory test.

Rendering tip: After opening the file in Kerkythea, go to *View → Adjust → Solid Rendering*, then switch to **Ambient Occlusion** before rendering. Left on the default Quick Render setting, the output will be rough and lack anti-aliasing.

Attached file: nz_01.zip (Kerkythea scene settings used in this test)

Original Japanese article: *Coffee Break.. Infinityのテスト*, PC-Trace blog, published 2024/11/20, category Kerkythea.